

Data Fluencies: Tributaries



29 May–

19 July 2025

Curated by: Roopa Vasudevan for
the Data Fluencies Project

Exhibition Documentation

Lani Asunción, JAZSALYN, Lai Yi Ohlsen, Kristoffer Ørum, Caroline Sindors and Roopa Vasudevan, with experimental research by the Night School for Data Fluencies, DATA/EFFECT and Data Fluencies Pedagogies

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The second of three thematically connected shows on view across North America in 2025, this exhibition investigates art's potential for reimagining our often narrow understandings of data and machine learning. Using the river tributary as a conceptual starting point, the artistic projects presented in this exhibition work together to explore the ways that critical, conceptual and creative investigation into the promises and pitfalls of our current understandings of data and technology might feed into broader, community-centred exploration, extending beyond the academic venues in which these ideas are traditionally discussed.

Data Fluencies: Tributaries features the work of six contemporary artists, alongside experimental research supported by the Data Fluencies Project, based out of the Digital Democracies Institute at Simon Fraser University. The exhibition aims to provide open public engagement with the research outputs emerging from the larger project and place them next to cutting-edge and critical work of artists examining the same themes and ideas. Together, the artists and researchers featured here offer us ways to (re)consider our relationships with the data that surrounds and drives our everyday lives—and perhaps find new routes to agency once we are able to do so.

Virtual Tour



Or Gallery | Data Fluencies: Tributaries

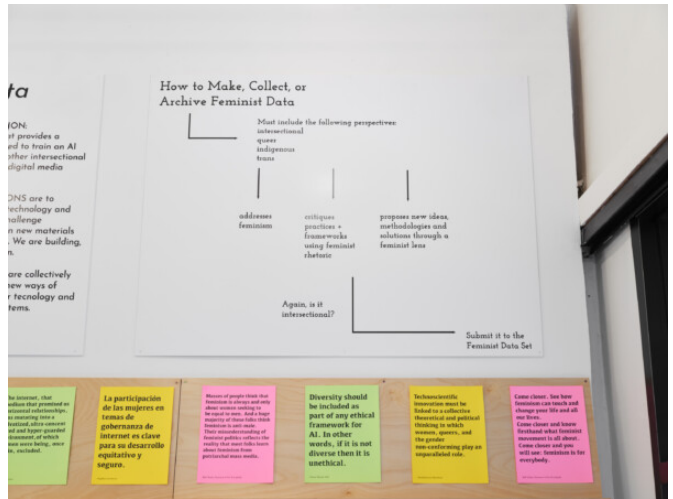
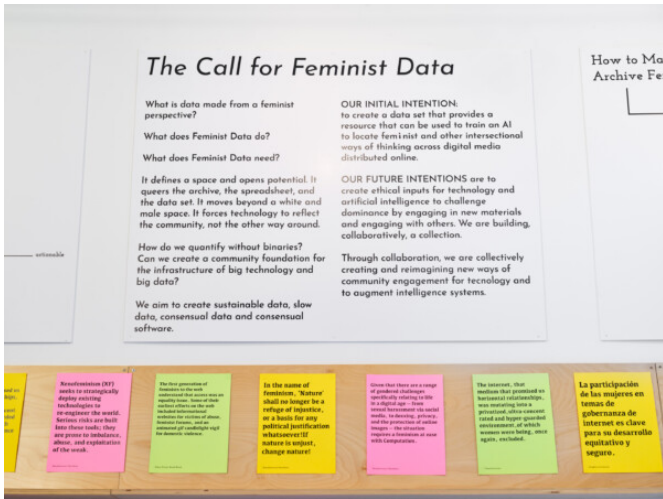
Or Gallery

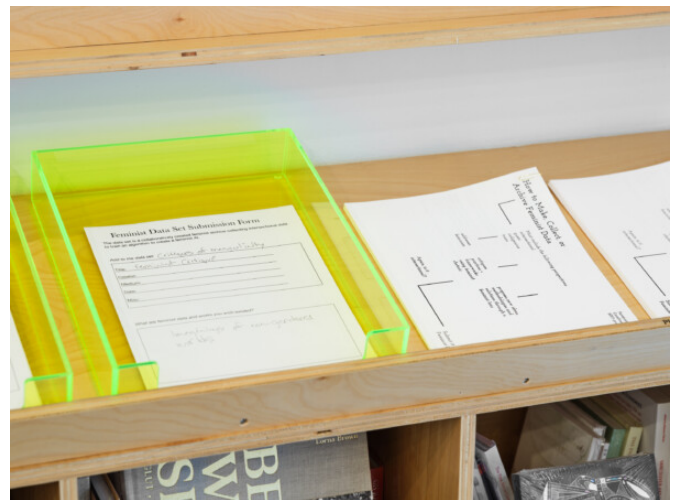


Watch on

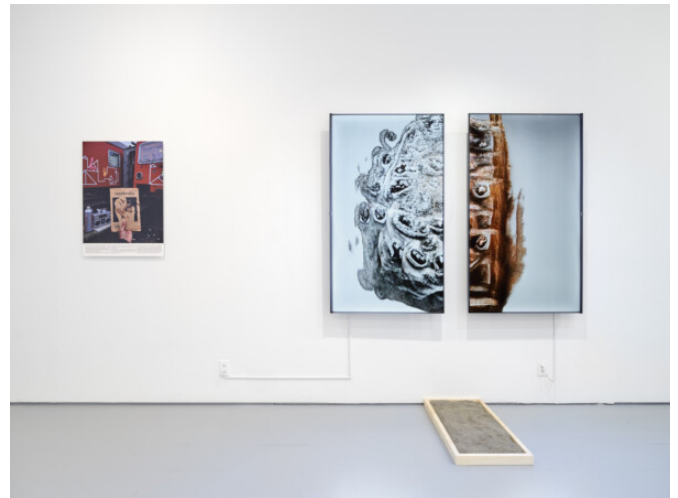
Exhibition Documentation

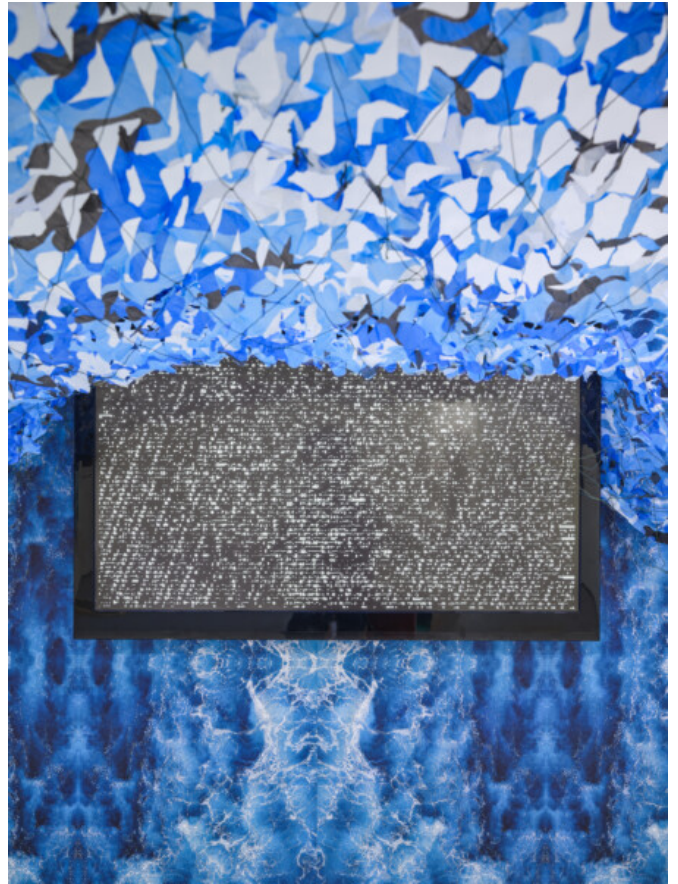




















Artist Bios

Lani Asunción

Lani Asunción is a multimedia artist who holds a Master of Fine Arts from UConn School of Fine Arts. Recipient of 2022 Public Art for Spatial Justice Grant from New England Foundation for the Arts. Asunción is a visiting lecturer at Massachusetts College of Art and Design teaching public art, performance, and Interdisciplinary Studio.

JAZSALYN

Jazsaly is an artist exploring data loss, memory restoration, and Ancestral Intelligence through alternative media and re-indigenization. Her work has been supported by Serpentine Arts Technologies, Pioneer Works, and more. She is the Artistic Director of Black Beyond and teaches at The New School, where she has written coursework on African and Diaspora rituals as speculative technology.

Lai Yi Ohlsen

Lai Yi Ohlsen is an artist and Internet researcher. Her creative work has been supported by NEW INC, Pioneer Works, Movement Research, Triple Canopy, BRIC and more. She is an adjunct lecturer at The New School and a Senior Product Manager at Cloudflare.

Kristoffer Ørum

Kristoffer Ørum is a multidisciplinary artist whose work examines the intersection of technology, memory, and imagination. Through innovative uses of AI and digital systems, he explores alternative narratives that challenge social and political norms. His internationally exhibited practice invites audiences to reimagine the possibilities of human-machine collaboration and collective storytelling.

Caroline Sinderson

Caroline Sinderson is an award winning critical designer, researcher, and artist. They are the founder of human rights and design lab, Convocation Research + Design, and a current BRAID fellow with the University of Arts, London. They have worked with the Tate Exchange at the Tate Modern, the United Nations, Ars Electronica's AI Lab, The Information Commissioner's Office (the UK's data protection and privacy regulator), the Harvard Kennedy School, and others.

Roopa Vasudevan

Roopa Vasudevan is a media artist, computer programmer, and scholar investigating sociotechnical defaults and protocols, and how they intersect with larger cultural and economic power structures. She has been supported by the Processing Foundation, Eyebeam, and NEW INC, among others, and is an Assistant Professor of Art at the University of Massachusetts Amherst.

The Imaginative Methods Lab

The Imaginative Methods Lab, founded by Gillian Russell and Frédéric Lesage, is a methods incubator dedicated to the design, analysis and deployment of research methods for collaborative imagining, prototyping, and experiencing different understandings of the present. *Fables For Imagining* was created in collaboration with Samein Shamsher, Craig Badke, Lauren Thu, and Pete Fung. Illustrations by Doan Truong.

DATA/FEET

DATA/FEET is Anthony Burton, Matt Canute, Craig Fahner, Ganaele Langlois and Rory Sharp. The collective is developing open-source software tools and methods that explore the relationships between algorithmic media, affect and mis- and dis-information.

Moments with Data

Moments with Data represents a collaboration among the researchers of the Data Fluencies project, along with workshop facilitators, instructors, and students who took part in the courses and workshops developed as part of the initiative.

Curator Bio

Data Fluencies Project

Based at the Digital Democracies Institute at Simon Fraser University, the Data Fluencies Project works to counter the impacts of discriminatory technology and online mis- and disinformation and foster more just and equitable futures. The project seeks to develop an expansive and interdisciplinary approach that combines the interpretative traditions of the arts and humanities with critical work in the social and data sciences to support innovative engagements with (and resistances to) our data-filled world. The 2025 Data Fluencies exhibitions were organized by Roopa Vasudevan, a co-PI on the project.

Related Events

Data Fluencies: Tributaries Virtual Artist Talk	Digital Futures Lab 6 Jun 2025
9 Jul 2025	



< PreviousNext >

Or Gallery acknowledges its presence on unceded xʷməθkʷəy̓əm, Skwxwú7mesh, and səliłwətał Territory.